

soprano

The highest of the four standard singing voices—above **alto**, **tenor**, and **bass**; term for a female or a young boy singing in this vocal range.

stave

The grid of five horizontal lines on which music is written; also called a “staff.”

suite

A multi-movement work—generally instrumental—made up of a series of contrasting dance movements, usually all in one **key**.

symphonic poem

An extended single-movement symphonic work, usually of a **programmatic** nature, often describing landscape or literary works. Also known as a tone poem.

symphony

A large-scale work for full orchestra; **Classical** and some **Romantic** symphonies both contain four movements—traditionally an allegro, a slower second movement, a scherzo, and a lively finale. The first movement is often in **sonata** form, and the slow movement and finale may follow a similar structure. Later symphonies can contain more or fewer movements.